Context & Creating: cheat sheet

Your notes are your context.

What you mirrored today

In the demo, an agent read a folder of markdown notes on Ian's Mac. In the hands-on, you built the same setup in a free Claude Project in your browser. This table shows which part of the Project stands in for which part of the vault.

In the demo (Ian's Mac)	In the hands-on (attendee browser)
CLAUDE.md	Project instructions
vault files	Project knowledge (pasted text)
Claude Code chat	Project chat
add a memory line	edit Project instructions
memory file	short rules go in Project instructions, long text in Project knowledge
skill	a 'When I say X, do this' block in the instructions

What you did in the hands-on

The minutes count from the start of the 20-minute hands-on block.

Min	Step
0-3	Make a Project. Paste the 5-line instructions template from the kit page and fill the blanks.
3-7	Paste the brand kit (Tarrant or personal template) and one sample doc into Project knowledge.
7-13	Ask for the 5-slide outline. Then: laptop with code execution asks for the .pptx and downloads it; phone asks for an SVG diagram in brand colors.
13-17	Add one rule to the Project instructions (examples on the kit page, such as "always flag numbers not in the source"). Start a new chat in the Project and ask again. Note what changed.
17-20	Share-outs: one thing that changed, one thing it got wrong.

The five prompts

Prompt 1, outline:

> Using the brand kit and the document in this Project, write a 5-slide briefing outline for my usual audience. Give each slide a title that states its takeaway, then at most five short bullets. Use only numbers that appear in the document, with units. Flag anything the document does not support. The five slides include a title slide. Keep every bullet to at most twelve words; count the words before you answer.

Prompt 2, .pptx (laptop with code execution on):

> Build that outline as a real .pptx file I can download. Use the brand kit colors and fonts and follow its slide rules. Write and run the Python code yourself, then give me the file.

Prompt 3, SVG (phone, or anyone without code execution):

> Draw a simple system diagram of what this document describes, as an SVG, using only the brand kit colors. Label every block and every arrow. Keep it readable on a phone screen.

Prompt 4, show the code:

> Show me the code you ran, and tell me in three lines what I would change to rerun it next month with a new document.

Prompt 5, re-ask after adding a rule:

> I added a rule to the Project instructions. Write the 5-slide outline again and tell me in one line what changed because of the rule.

Add a rule

Add one line like these to your Project instructions, then run Prompt 5 to see what it changes.

1. Always flag numbers that are not in the source document.
2. Put the ask or decision on slide 1, not the last slide.
3. End every outline with the open questions the source does not answer.

Two rules for cloud tools

No employer data in cloud tools. Bring a document only if it is non-confidential.

Paste text, never upload files.

Tier map: free, paid and local

These facts come from a check on 2026-10-13. Plans and prices change often, so each line says whether it was confirmed on the vendor's own page. Treat anything marked unverified as a lead to check, not a promise.

Tier	Fact	Status
Free	ChatGPT Free: 3 file uploads a day.	unverified as of 2026-10-13
Free	Claude Free: 5 Projects.	**verified 2026-10-13**
Free	Claude Free: Artifacts included.	**verified 2026-10-13**
Free	Claude Free: code execution behind Settings > Capabilities.	**verified 2026-10-13**
Free	Claude Free: rolling 5-hour usage limit.	**verified 2026-10-13**
Free	NotebookLM free: mind maps and slide decks.	unverified as of 2026-10-13
Free	ChatGPT, Gemini and Copilot free tiers train on your data by default.	unverified as of 2026-10-13
Paid	ChatGPT Go $8.	unverified as of 2026-10-13
Paid	Claude Pro $20.	**verified 2026-10-13**
Paid	Google AI Pro $19.99.	**verified 2026-10-13**
Paid	Microsoft 365 Personal $9.99.	**verified 2026-10-13**
Local	Local apps (LM Studio, Ollama, GPT4All): chat over documents offline, no decks.	unverified as of 2026-10-13

The parallel Green workshop covers the tooling that acts on your files, which is the next step after a Project.

Project today, vault plus agent when you are ready.